

1949, February 20

The following is a faithful transcription of the carbon copy of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX FRIARY

HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

February 20th, 1949

(Very Rev. Edmund Kramer)

Dear Rev. Father Provincial:

No doubt you will have been expecting a report of some kind concerning the privileged trip conceded me recently to the Funeral of poor, dear brother, Father Maurice Joachim. I started to do this the day after the solemnities; for all considered it was a real solemn funeral and seemingly a happy one. Blessed be God in His angels and in His saints.

A wire at about 7:30 Wednesday, January 12 from Ortonville, Minn. announced to us: "Father Maurice Joachim died at 6:20 this Morning". I erroneously took it for almost self understood that the Funeral would take place on Saturday, waiting for more particulars till near midnight, when a call came; but it was from a poor party - convert - lamenting their unfortunate divorce.

Your Very Rev. Paternity, on my long distance call had benignly bidden me go thither. Deo gratias. We concluded that possibly the funeral might be Friday and decided accordingly to take no chances. Hence, our plans to catch the Hiawatha as probably - surest train to make the desired connections.

It snowed that Thursday morning and to be sure of catching the "Golden Arrow" train on the Pennsylvania, we left early, for Ft. Wayne; - Brother Cook, Ignatius at the wheel and Rev. Father Guardian accompanying. Leaving Fort Wayne, the Conductor had to lament that he was 25 minutes late, which to me meant that we'd be nip and tuck in catching the Hiawatha in Chicago, if we didn't lose any more on the schedule thither. On leaving Huntington, however, we had said our Rosary for Divine guidance and protection and safe return and thanks be to God, I forgot all about worrying. We made it, even if the train had to wait a little, till they kindly got me a ticket.

I was still figuring on the Funeral being on Saturday and on my staying over night in St. Paul till, the first passenger off the Coach, my friends held me up. I had to go back on the train and they